TRANSPARENCY, ACCOUNTABILITY, RTI, GRIEVANCE REDRESS AND SOCIAL AUDIT

TRANSPARENCY TO CONSEQUENCE → INFORMATION-REQUEST ROUTE CARD → EXEMPTIONS AND THE OVERRIDE → THE SUBSTITUTED EXEMPTION → SOCIAL AUDIT STATUTORY BASIS → TWO LAYERS, ONE AUDIT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — TRANSPARENCY TO CONSEQUENCE

TRANSPARENCY TO CONSEQUENCE · VISIBILITY OF RECORDS, SPENDING AND DECISIONS · AN IDENTIFIABLE AUTHORITY OBLIGED TO EXPLAIN · CORRECTION, REMEDY OR CONSEQUENCE · INDIAN PATTERN · FIRST BUILT EXTENSIVELY, SECOND UNEVENLY, THIRD RARELY · MUST REMEMBER · ACCOUNTABILITY REQUIRES AN ACTOR, FORUM, INFORMATION, QUESTIONING

TRANSPARENCY → visibility of records, spending and decisions → ANSWERABILITY → an identifiable authority obliged to explain → ENFORCEABILITY → correction, remedy or consequence → INDIAN PATTERN → first built extensively, second unevenly, third rarely → MUST REMEMBER: Accountability requires an actor, forum, information, questioning

CORE CLAIM
- TRANSPARENCY → visibility of records, spending and decisions
- ANSWERABILITY → an identifiable authority obliged to explain

MECHANISM
- ENFORCEABILITY → correction, remedy or consequence
- INDIAN PATTERN → first built extensively, second unevenly, third rarely

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Accountability requires an actor, forum, information, questioning…
- TRANSPARENCY → visibility of records, spending and decisions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Accountability requires an actor, forum, information, questioning..

01

STAGE 01 — INFORMATION-REQUEST ROUTE CARD

INFORMATION-REQUEST ROUTE CARD · ORDINARY REPLY · 30 DAYS FROM THE PUBLIC INFORMATION OFFICER · LIFE OR LIBERTY · 48 HOURS · FIRST APPEAL ORDINARILY WITHIN 30 DAYS; SECOND APPEAL WITHIN · TWO HUNDRED AND FIFTY RUPEES PER DAY UP TO · OBTAINS EXISTING INFORMATION; CANNOT CREATE IT OR ORDER A

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ORDINARY REPLY → 30 days from the public information officer	APPEALS → first appeal ordinarily within 30 days; second appeal within 90 days	LIMIT → obtains existing information; cannot create it or order a service
LIFE OR LIBERTY → 48 hours	PENALTY → two hundred and fifty rupees per day up to twenty-five thousand rupees	ORDINARY REPLY → 30 days from the public information officer

CORE CLAIM
- ORDINARY REPLY → 30 days from the public information officer
- LIFE OR LIBERTY → 48 hours

MECHANISM
- APPEALS → first appeal ordinarily within 30 days; second appeal within 90 days
- PENALTY → two hundred and fifty rupees per day up to twenty-five thousand rupees

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LIMIT → obtains existing information; cannot create it or order a service
- ORDINARY REPLY → 30 days from the public information officer

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → obtains existing information; cannot create it or order a service.

02

STAGE 02 — EXEMPTIONS AND THE OVERRIDE

EXEMPTIONS AND THE OVERRIDE · SECTION 8, APPLIED CLAUSE BY CLAUSE · AN EXEMPT PART DOES NOT WITHHOLD THE WHOLE RECORD · SECTION 8(2) PERMITS DISCLOSURE WHERE PUBLIC INTEREST OUTWEIGHS HARM · SECTION 24 FOR LISTED ORGANISATIONS, WITH CORRUPTION AND RIGHTS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
EXEMPTIONS → section 8, applied clause by clause	OVERRIDE → section 8(2) permits disclosure where public interest outweighs harm	EXEMPTIONS → section 8, applied clause by clause
SEVERABILITY → an exempt part does not withhold the whole record	EXCLUSION → section 24 for listed organisations, with corruption and rights provisos preserved	SEVERABILITY → an exempt part does not withhold the whole record

CORE CLAIM
- EXEMPTIONS → section 8, applied clause by clause
- SEVERABILITY → an exempt part does not withhold the whole record

MECHANISM
- OVERRIDE → section 8(2) permits disclosure where public interest outweighs harm
- EXCLUSION → section 24 for listed organisations, with corruption and rights provisos preserved

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EXEMPTIONS → section 8, applied clause by clause
- SEVERABILITY → an exempt part does not withhold the whole record

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXCLUSION → section 24 for listed organisations, with corruption and rights provisos preserved.

03

STAGE 03 — THE SUBSTITUTED EXEMPTION

THE SUBSTITUTED EXEMPTION · THE PRE-SUBSTITUTION PERSONAL-INFORMATION TEST, NOW SUPERSEDED · 13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025 · SECTION 44(3) SUBSTITUTION TAKES EFFECT IN THE IMMEDIATE TRANCHE · THE SECTION 8(2) PUBLIC-INTEREST OVERRIDE REMAINS AVAILABLE · CONSTITUTIONAL CHALLENGES FILED; NO FINAL JUDGMENT LOCATED AS OF

BEFORE → the pre-substitution personal-information test, now superseded → 13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025 → section 44(3) substitution takes effect in the immediate tranche → UNAFFECTED → the section 8(2) public-interest override remains available → PENDING → constitutional challenges filed; no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026

CORE CLAIM
- BEFORE → the pre-substitution personal-information test, now superseded
- 13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025 → section 44(3) substitution takes effect in the immediate tranche

MECHANISM
- UNAFFECTED → the section 8(2) public-interest override remains available
- PENDING → constitutional challenges filed; no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BEFORE → the pre-substitution personal-information test, now superseded
- 13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025 → section 44(3) substitution takes effect in the immediate tranche

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PENDING → constitutional challenges filed; no final judgment located as of 13 August 2026.

04

STAGE 04 — SOCIAL AUDIT STATUTORY BASIS

SOCIAL AUDIT STATUTORY BASIS · SECTION 17 · THE GRAM SABHA HOLDS THE MONITORING AND SOCIAL-AUDIT FUNCTION · RULES OF 2011 · AN INDEPENDENT STATE SOCIAL AUDIT UNIT FACILITATES THE AUDIT · AT LEAST ONCE EVERY SIX MONTHS IN EVERY GRAM · PUBLIC HEARING FOLLOWED BY A MANDATED FOLLOW-UP PROCESS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SECTION 17 → the Gram Sabha holds the monitoring and social-audit function	CYCLE → at least once every six months in every Gram Panchayat	SECTION 17 → the Gram Sabha holds the monitoring and social-audit function
RULES OF 2011 → an independent State Social Audit Unit facilitates the audit	COMPLETION → public hearing followed by a mandated follow-up process	RULES OF 2011 → an independent State Social Audit Unit facilitates the audit

CORE CLAIM
- SECTION 17 → the Gram Sabha holds the monitoring and social-audit function
- RULES OF 2011 → an independent State Social Audit Unit facilitates the audit

MECHANISM
- CYCLE → at least once every six months in every Gram Panchayat
- COMPLETION → public hearing followed by a mandated follow-up process

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SECTION 17 → the Gram Sabha holds the monitoring and social-audit function
- RULES OF 2011 → an independent State Social Audit Unit facilitates the audit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPLETION → public hearing followed by a mandated follow-up process.

05

STAGE 05 — TWO LAYERS, ONE AUDIT

TWO LAYERS, ONE AUDIT · COMMUNITY LAYER · LOCAL KNOWLEDGE, PUBLIC LEGITIMACY, PRESENCE OF THE AFFECTED PEOPLE · INDEPENDENT UNIT · FACILITATION, RECORD ACCESS, TRAINING, SEPARATION FROM THE IMPLEMENTER · CAPTURE RISK · PRESENT AT BOTH LAYERS AND NOT REMOVED BY EITHER · MORE INDEPENDENCE REDUCES CAPTURE AND REDUCES HYPER-LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
COMMUNITY LAYER → local knowledge, public legitimacy, presence of the affected people	CAPTURE RISK → present at both layers and not removed by either alone	COMMUNITY LAYER → local knowledge, public legitimacy, presence of the affected people
INDEPENDENT UNIT → facilitation, record access, training, separation from the implementer	TRADE-OFF → more independence reduces capture and reduces hyper-local knowledge	INDEPENDENT UNIT → facilitation, record access, training, separation from the implementer

CORE CLAIM
- COMMUNITY LAYER → local knowledge, public legitimacy, presence of the affected people
- INDEPENDENT UNIT → facilitation, record access, training, separation from the implementer

MECHANISM
- CAPTURE RISK → present at both layers and not removed by either alone
- TRADE-OFF → more independence reduces capture and reduces hyper-local knowledge

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COMMUNITY LAYER → local knowledge, public legitimacy, presence of the affected people
- INDEPENDENT UNIT → facilitation, record access, training, separation from the implementer

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRADE-OFF → more independence reduces capture and reduces hyper-local knowledge.

06

STAGE 06 — TWO TESTS THAT DECIDE QUALITY

TWO TESTS THAT DECIDE QUALITY · INDEPENDENCE TEST · IS THE FACILITATOR STRUCTURALLY SEPARATE FROM THE AUDITED DEPARTMENT · FOLLOW-UP TEST · DOES A FINDING TRIGGER TIMED RECOVERY, DISCIPLINE OR PROCESS · PRODUCED BY THE PUBLIC HEARING ITSELF · PRODUCED ONLY BY THE MANDATED ACTION-TAKEN PROCESS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
INDEPENDENCE TEST → is the facilitator structurally separate from the audited department	ANSWERABILITY → produced by the public hearing itself	INDEPENDENCE TEST → is the facilitator structurally separate from the audited department
FOLLOW-UP TEST → does a finding trigger timed recovery, discipline or process correction	ENFORCEABILITY → produced only by the mandated action-taken process	FOLLOW-UP TEST → does a finding trigger timed recovery, discipline or process correction

CORE CLAIM
- INDEPENDENCE TEST → is the facilitator structurally separate from the audited department
- FOLLOW-UP TEST → does a finding trigger timed recovery, discipline or process correction

MECHANISM
- ANSWERABILITY → produced by the public hearing itself
- ENFORCEABILITY → produced only by the mandated action-taken process

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- INDEPENDENCE TEST → is the facilitator structurally separate from the audited department
- FOLLOW-UP TEST → does a finding trigger timed recovery, discipline or process correction

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ENFORCEABILITY → produced only by the mandated action-taken process.

07

STAGE 07 — VISIBILITY TO CORRECTION

VISIBILITY TO CORRECTION · PUBLISHED BUT SOMETIMES AGGREGATED, TECHNICAL OR STALE · INTELLIGIBLE TO THE AFFECTED PERSON, IN THEIR OWN LANGUAGE · RECORD COMPARED AGAINST REALITY BY AN INDEPENDENT FACILITATOR · A NAMED OFFICIAL EXPLAINS IN PUBLIC, ON THE RECORD · FOLLOW-UP AND CONSEQUENCE · ACTION-TAKEN REPORT, RECOVERY, DISCIPLINE; THE USUAL BREAK POINT

DISCLOSURE → published but sometimes aggregated, technical or stale → COMPREHENSION → intelligible to the affected person, in their own language → VERIFICATION → record compared against reality by an independent facilitator → ANSWERABILITY → a named official explains in public, on the record → FOLLOW-UP AND CONSEQUENCE → action-taken report, recovery, discipline; the usual break point

CORE CLAIM
- DISCLOSURE → published but sometimes aggregated, technical or stale
- COMPREHENSION → intelligible to the affected person, in their own language

MECHANISM
- VERIFICATION → record compared against reality by an independent facilitator
- ANSWERABILITY → a named official explains in public, on the record

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FOLLOW-UP AND CONSEQUENCE → action-taken report, recovery, discipline; the usual break point
- DISCLOSURE → published but sometimes aggregated, technical or stale

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FOLLOW-UP AND CONSEQUENCE → action-taken report, recovery, discipline; the usual break point.

08

STAGE 08 — ACCOUNTABILITY TYPOLOGY

ACCOUNTABILITY TYPOLOGY · PUBLIC AUDIT, LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEES, VIGILANCE, OMBUDSMAN, COURTS, REGULATORS · ELECTIONS, LEGISLATIVE QUESTIONING, POLITICAL COMPETITION · INFORMATION REQUESTS, SOCIAL AUDIT, PUBLIC HEARINGS, REPORT CARDS, MEDIA · COUPLING RULE · SOCIAL ANSWERABILITY NEEDS A HORIZONTAL INSTRUMENT TO SUPPLY CONSEQUENCE

HORIZONTAL → public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, ombudsman, courts, regulators

VERTICAL → elections, legislative questioning, political competition · SOCIAL → information requests, social audit, public hearings, report cards, media · COUPLING RULE → social answerability needs a horizontal instrument to supply consequence

CORE CLAIM
- HORIZONTAL → public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, ombudsman, courts, regulators
- VERTICAL → elections, legislative questioning, political competition

MECHANISM
- SOCIAL → information requests, social audit, public hearings, report cards, media
- COUPLING RULE → social answerability needs a horizontal instrument to supply consequence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- HORIZONTAL → public audit, legislative committees, vigilance, ombudsman, courts, regulators
- VERTICAL → elections, legislative questioning, political competition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COUPLING RULE → social answerability needs a horizontal instrument to supply consequence.

09

STAGE 09 — INSTITUTIONAL DIVISION OF LABOUR

INSTITUTIONAL DIVISION OF LABOUR · PUBLIC AUDITOR · ARTICLES 148 TO 151; FINANCIAL, COMPLIANCE AND PERFORMANCE AUDIT · VIGILANCE COMMISSION · ACT OF 2003; SUPERINTENDENCE AND ADVICE, NOT CONVICTION · CORRUPTION OMBUDSMAN · ACT OF 2013; INQUIRY INTO COVERED CORRUPTION COMPLAINTS · GRIEVANCE PLATFORM

PUBLIC AUDITOR → Articles 148 to 151; financial, compliance and performance audit → VIGILANCE COMMISSION → Act of 2003; superintendence and advice, not conviction → CORRUPTION OMBUDSMAN → Act of 2013; inquiry into covered corruption complaints → GRIEVANCE PLATFORM → 21-day redress and 30-day appeal benchmarks, August 2024 guidelines → CLOSE DISTINCTION: RTI disclosure is not grievance adjudication, CAG audit is not

CORE CLAIM
- PUBLIC AUDITOR → Articles 148 to 151; financial, compliance and performance audit
- VIGILANCE COMMISSION → Act of 2003; superintendence and advice, not conviction

MECHANISM
- CORRUPTION OMBUDSMAN → Act of 2013; inquiry into covered corruption complaints
- GRIEVANCE PLATFORM → 21-day redress and 30-day appeal benchmarks, August 2024 guidelines

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: RTI disclosure is not grievance adjudication, CAG audit is not…
- PUBLIC AUDITOR → Articles 148 to 151; financial, compliance and performance audit

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: RTI disclosure is not grievance adjudication, CAG audit is not.

10

STAGE 10 — ROUTING THE REMEDY

ROUTING THE REMEDY · INFORMATION DENIED · PUBLIC INFORMATION OFFICER, FIRST APPEAL, INFORMATION COMMISSION · SERVICE DELAYED · DEPARTMENT, NOTIFIED SERVICE-GUARANTEE ROUTE, GRIEVANCE PLATFORM · MONEY MISSUED · SOCIAL AUDIT, PERFORMANCE AUDIT, LEGISLATIVE SCRUTINY · VIGILANCE, CORRUPTION OMBUDSMAN, INVESTIGATIVE AGENCY

INFORMATION DENIED → public information officer, first appeal, Information Commission → SERVICE DELAYED → department, notified service-guarantee route, grievance platform → MONEY MISSUED → social audit, performance audit, legislative scrutiny → CORRUPTION → vigilance, corruption ombudsman, investigative agency → PERSONAL-DATA BREACH → not an operative route until the Board is appointed and duties commence

CORE CLAIM
- INFORMATION DENIED → public information officer, first appeal, Information Commission
- SERVICE DELAYED → department, notified service-guarantee route, grievance platform

MECHANISM
- MONEY MISSUED → social audit, performance audit, legislative scrutiny
- CORRUPTION → vigilance, corruption ombudsman, investigative agency

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PERSONAL-DATA BREACH → not an operative route until the Board is appointed and duties commence
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Apply RTI Act sections 4, 8, 10, 19 and 20…

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Apply RTI Act sections 4, 8, 10, 19 and 20.

11

STAGE 11 — ANSWER SPINE FOR AN ACCOUNTABILITY DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR AN ACCOUNTABILITY DEMAND · TRANSPARENCY, ANSWERABILITY AND ENFORCEABILITY SEPARATED IN SENTENCE ONE · MAP THE ECOSYSTEM, THEN APPLY THE INDEPENDENCE AND FOLLOW-UP · MANDATED ACTION-TAKEN PROCESS, INDEPENDENT FACILITATION, PROTECTION FOR REPORTERS · GRADED VERDICT, CURRENT-STATUS CAVEAT WITH DATES, AND STATED QUESTION

OPEN → transparency, answerability and enforceability separated in sentence one → BUILD → map the ecosystem, then apply the independence and follow-up tests to one case → CORRECT → mandated action-taken process, independent facilitation, protection for reporters → CLOSE → graded verdict, current-status caveat with dates, and stated question ownership

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → transparency, answerability and enforceability separated in sentence one
- BUILD → map the ecosystem, then apply the independence and follow-up tests to one case

MECHANISM
- CORRECT → mandated action-taken process, independent facilitation, protection for reporters
- CLOSE → graded verdict, current-status caveat with dates, and stated question ownership

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OPEN → transparency, answerability and enforceability separated in sentence one
- BUILD → map the ecosystem, then apply the independence and follow-up tests to one case

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict, current-status caveat with dates, and stated question ownership.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE GRAM SABHA LAYER FACES A STRUCTURAL TENSION · THE SAME COMMUNITY THAT MAY · STATUTORY SOCIAL AUDIT (MGNREGA, MEGHALAYA) DEMONSTRATES THE BROADER ACCOUNTABILITY · CPGRAMS-STYLE INDIVIDUAL GRIEVANCE REDRESS AND SOCIAL AUDIT ARE COMPLEMENTARY · MGNREGA'S SECTION 17 FRAMEWORK IS OPERATIONALISED THROUGH THE STATUTORY · THE MEGHALAYA COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION AND PUBLIC SERVICES SOCIAL AUDIT · WIDER REPLICATION OF MEGHALAYA-STYLE GENERALISED SOCIAL-AUDIT LEGISLATION (COVERING

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: The Gram Sabha layer faces a structural tension: the same community that may
- CAUTION: Statutory social audit (MGNREGA, Meghalaya) demonstrates the broader accountability
- CAUTION: CPGRAMS-style individual grievance redress and social audit are complementary but
- MGNREGA's Section 17 framework is operationalised through the statutory 2011 Rules,

ADVANCED DEBATE
- The Meghalaya Community Participation and Public Services Social Audit Act, 2017
- CAUTION: Wider replication of Meghalaya-style generalised social-audit legislation (covering
- CAUTION: A Gram Sabha social audit that identifies a contractor billing for unexecuted rural-road
- CAUTION: Boundary case: a jan sunwai that publicly surfaces discrepancies but where the

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: Extending a Meghalaya-style dedicated Social Audit Unit to audit non-MGNREGA welfare
- CAUTION: Greater auditor independence (dedicated Social Audit Units) reduces local-power capture
- CAUTION: Mandating follow-up enforcement (recovery, disciplinary action) strengthens
- CAUTION: Statutory social-audit legislation adds a genuine administrative and fiscal burden

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels